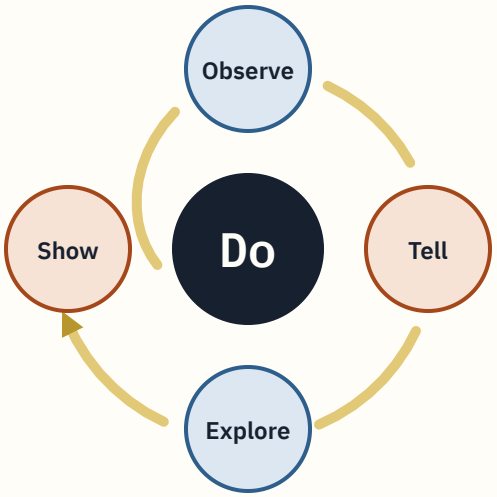
525,600 MINUTES · MEASURECAMP DC

Dotes

A way to record what you learned by living it, in your own words, in a form AI can read.

FIVE ELEMENTS, ONE SPIRAL



Show & Tell is the student's way. **Observe & Explore** is the scientist's, loosely the scientific method.

D	**Do**	What happened, and what did you do? The record.
O	**Observe**	*Afterthought.* What went well, what didn't, and what did you learn?
T	**Tell**	How would you tell it to someone else? The story.
E	**Explore**	*Forethought.* What would you do differently, and what are you still wondering?
S	**Show**	What makes it real? Evidence, shared with permission.

The spiral starts at Do and moves outward. **Do** is the record; **Tell** is the story.

ONE DOTE: A FIRST SUMMER JOB

Do	Junior counselor at a rec center day camp. Two eight-year-olds started shoving over the kickball, and I had to handle it.
Observe	Taking the ball away made it worse. Hearing each kid out, separately, worked. Being fair and being in charge are different things.
Tell	"Same story: each of them thought it was his turn. We made a rule that afternoon: whoever lost the last round picks first. By Friday, the kids were enforcing it themselves."
Explore	Apply for senior counselor next summer. How do coaches learn to settle arguments?
Show	A photo of the rule on the camp whiteboard. A note from the senior counselor.

THE FORMAL DEFINITION

An AI-ready narrative ontology for the first-person recordation of lived learning experiences. Axiomatic to narrative and relational identity development and the cultivation of AI Representatives.

dotes.xyz · michael@intospatia.xyz · Free to use under CC BY 4.0

THE SEVEN CATEGORIES

Seven lenses, not seven boxes

The author picks the primary lens. One story can be seen through several.

Character. What was at stake in your choice?

Service. Who or what did you help?

Adventure. What was new, and what did it open?

Wellbeing. What did you learn about living well?

Excellence. What were you working toward?

Relationships. How did the connection change?

Making. What did you bring into being?

For analysts. What could you count across a thousand dotes?

STAR, KOLB AND DOTES

	STAR	Kolb's learning cycle	Dotes
Built for	Answering one interview question	Describing how people learn from experience	Recording what one person learned, in their own words
Shape	A line: Situation, Task, Action, Result	A loop: experience, reflection, forming ideas, trying them out	A spiral around Do, joining Show and Tell with Observe and Explore
Leaves behind	One answer for one listener	Nothing; it's a model, not a record	A lasting, revisable record the person owns

The Dotes spiral. Every dote spirals out from Do through Observe, Tell, Explore and Show. Show and Tell are the student's way; Observe and Explore, the scientist's. Observe looks back (afterthought). Explore looks ahead (forethought).

TRY ONE

Do _____

Observe _____

Tell _____

Explore _____

Show _____

Keep this. It's yours.

Dotes is open: the canon, sample dotes, prompts, a schema and the name itself, free to use and remix under CC BY 4.0.

dotes.xyz

Michael Robbins · michael@intospatia.xyz · linkedin.com/in/mwrxyz